

Listing photo

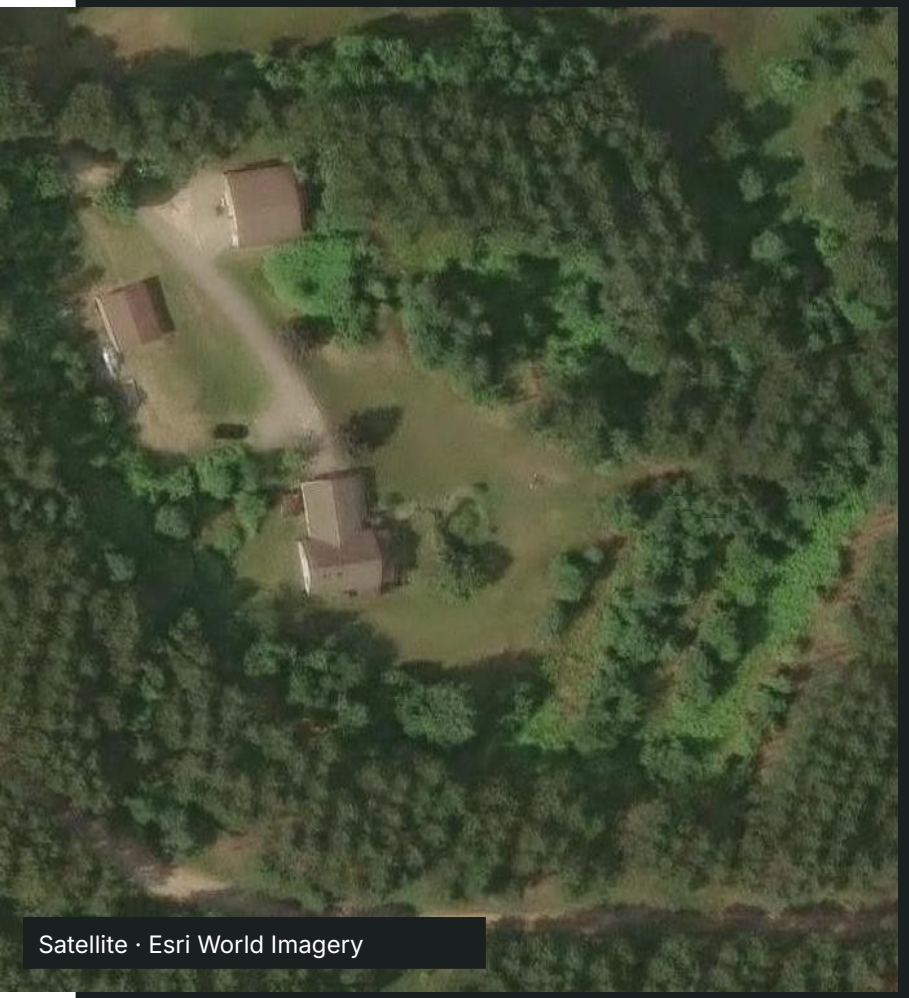
5312 Samels Rd Project Vision

Clark Huang & Jenny Roes · Williamsburg, near Traverse City, MI

Live 3D model and site: clarkhuang.github.io/5312-samels-rd

October 2026

SAMELS RD



Satellite · Esri World Imagery

Six wooded acres, a 1997 chalet, four buildings

6.00 acres

Wooded, sloped lot ~698 × 413 ft with ~40 ft of relief. Zoned A-1 Agricultural, Whitewater Twp. Private gravel road.

2,380 sf chalet

1.5-story, built 1997: 1,480 sf above grade + 900 sf walk-out lower. Metal roof, propane forced air, central air.

4 bed · 3 bath

2 main, 1 loft, 1 lower; 2 full + 1 ¾ bath. Lower family room 29′9″ × 19′9″. Lily pond east of the deck.

4 buildings

Pole barn 32 × 38 (insulated, subpanel), second garage ~28 × 30 (est.), attached 2-car garage, small shed.

Site plan

The chalet sits mid-lot, ~200 ft off Samels Rd. Deck and walk-out face east to the pond; both barns cluster at the drive. Guest suite spot is a future option only.

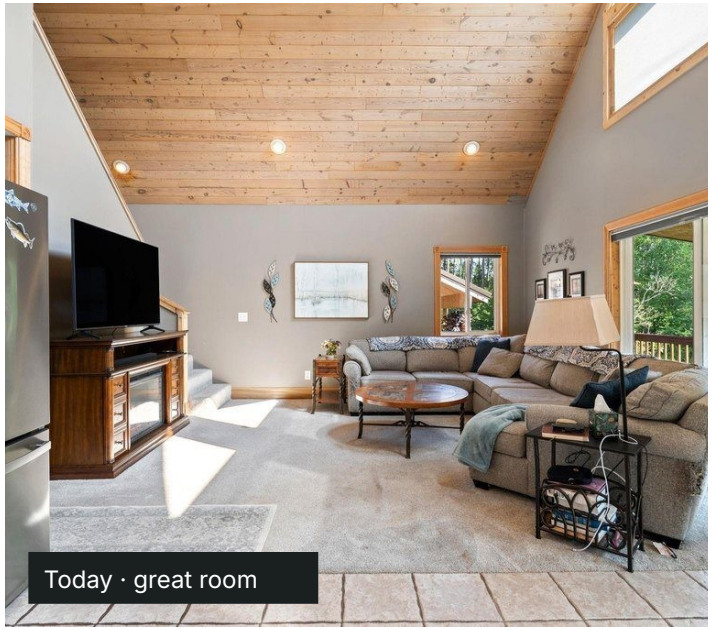


Modern, not country: one idea per level



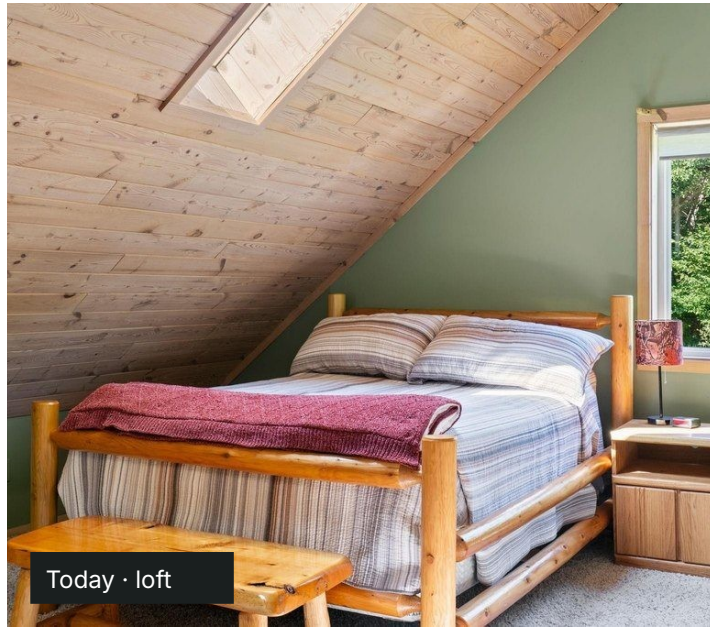
Lower · master retreat

Clean, fresh, modern and cozy: primary suite, sitting/TV room, morning coffee at the walk-out.



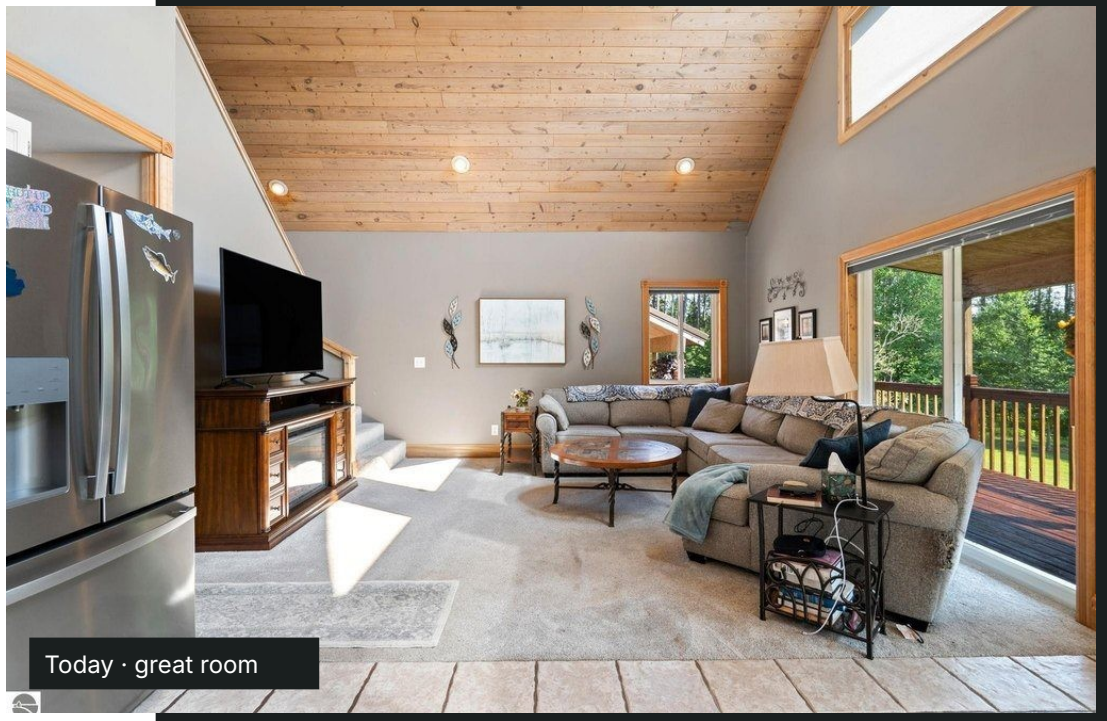
Main · entertaining

Lounge under the kept pine ceiling, island for four, two offices (one doubles for guests); dinners on the deck.



Loft · guests

Guest loft: a twin under the eave plus a queen. Warm white walls, oak floor; pine kept (paint optional).



Today · great room



Concept rendering

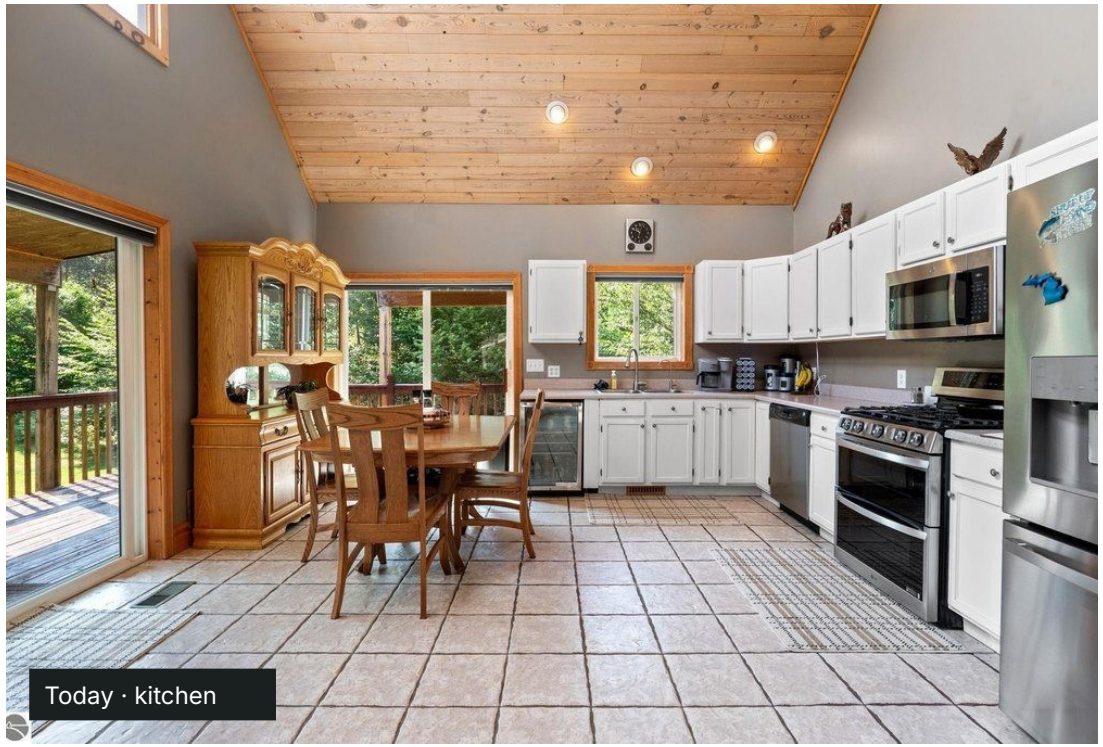
Great room: a lounge under the pine ceiling

Keeps the knotty-pine ceiling and honey trim; warm white walls, a mid-oak floor and lamplight work with the wood. Living 16 × 12 ft (listing): 7-ft sofa, two cigar chairs (~3 × 3 ft, est.) and the tufted bench leave ~3 ft paths. Steinway B (6′11″ × ~4′10″) sits by the stair; ~4-ft mirrored panel above the sofa; slim bar cabinet on the side wall.

Fit flag: the piano and the island both want the old dining zone (15 ft, listing). Tape both out at the visit.

Island for four, under the same wood

Kitchen 14 ft and dining 15 ft (listing, one dimension each). A 9 × 3.5 ft quartz island with four 24-in stools needs ~3.5 ft aisles, so it takes the dining table's spot ($6K / $11K / $20K, est.). Cabinets, appliances and the pine ceiling stay. Dinners move to the deck (6-ft round teak, ~$4,369).

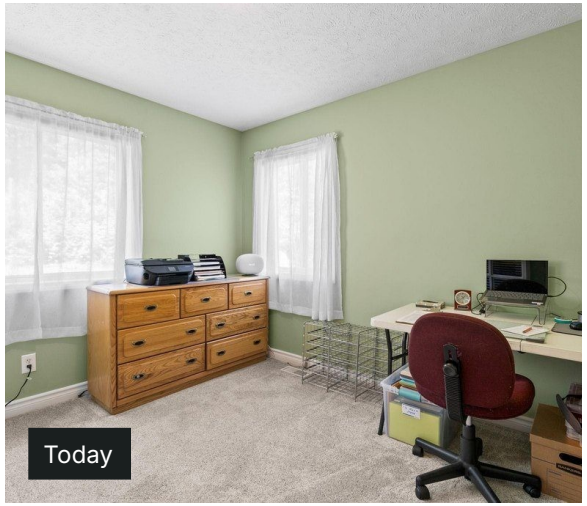


Today · kitchen



Concept rendering

Main floor: two offices, one guest overflow

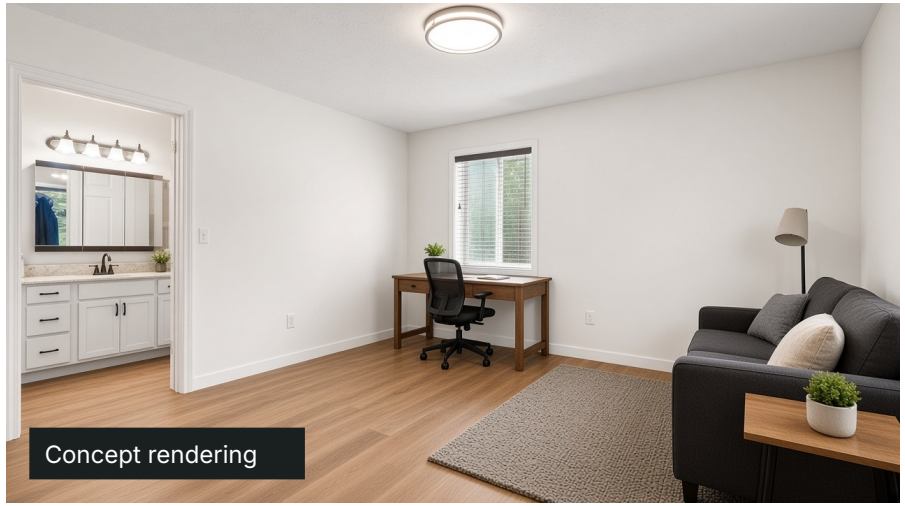




Office · 11 × 9 ft

Bedroom 3 (listing). Seabreeze glass-top desk + Aeron facing the window, one low credenza. Desk ~5 × 2.5 ft (est., not logged) + ~3 ft chair zone leaves ~3 ft clear.





Office + guest · 13 × 13 ft

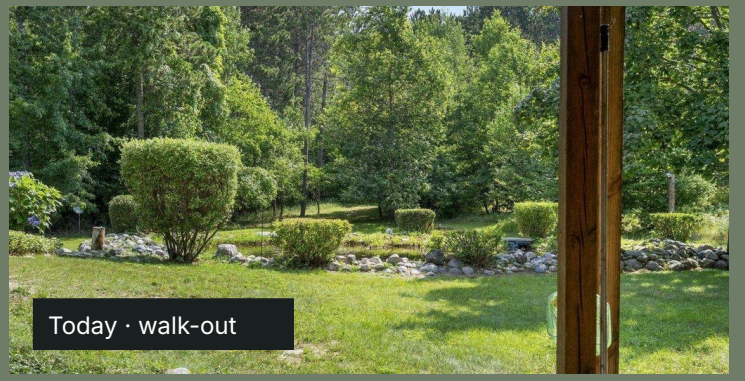
Today's primary (listing); keeps its direct door to the main bath. Second desk + full sleeper sofa (~7 × 3 ft closed, ~7 × 7 open, est.). Opened, ~3 ft stays clear to the bath and hall.



Concept rendering



Today · lower bedroom



Today · walk-out

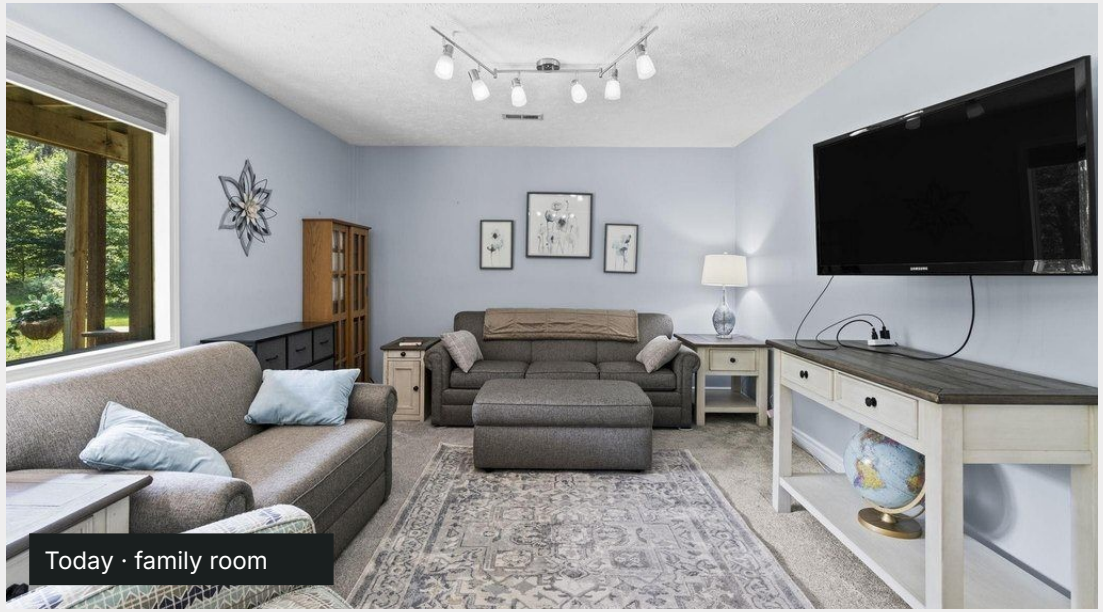
Lower master: a king, nothing extra

Bedroom 4 · 15 × 12 ft (listing). A king (6′4″ × 6′8″) and two 2-ft nightstands on the 15-ft wall leave ~2.3 ft each side and ~5 ft at the foot. New king (none in the Seabreeze inventory).

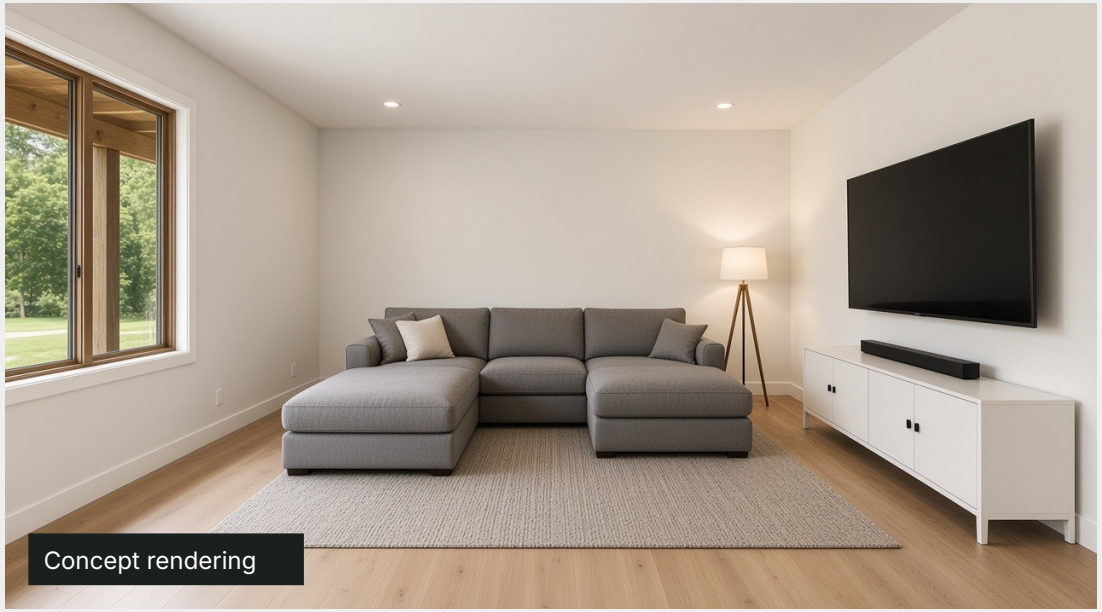
Solid doors replace the French doors; morning coffee out the walk-out. Check egress: ≥5.7 sf open, sill ≤44 in.

Lower sitting / TV room

Family room 29 × 19 ft (listing). The Seabreeze gray sectional (size not logged; ~11 × 6 ft placeholder) fits with ~9–10 ft to the 75″ TV on the white console and 3 ft paths to the sliders. If it won't split for delivery, use an 8–9 ft sofa instead.



Today · family room



Concept rendering





Guest loft: twin under the eave, queen beside

Bedroom 2 · 19 × 14 ft (listing), sloped pine ceiling kept. Twin (3′3″ × 6′3″) runs lengthwise under the low slope; queen (5′ × 6′8″) sits at full height beside it, with ~3 ft between beds and a clear path to the stair (est.; measure the knee wall). Sleeps three.

Lower bath: two options

Today ~5 × 9 ft (est.; the listing gives no bath sizes).
Long, narrow: vanity, toilet, 5-ft tub.


Concept rendering · A

A · Keep the footprint

$18–30K (est.)

Walk-in shower with glass panel, large warm-greige porcelain, 60-in floating oak double vanity, LED mirror light, matching toilet.

Fit: tight. 60-in vanity + toilet + ~32-in shower ≈ 10 ft vs ~9 ft (est.); may need a 48-in vanity.


Today · lower bath


Concept rendering · B

B · Borrow the craft room

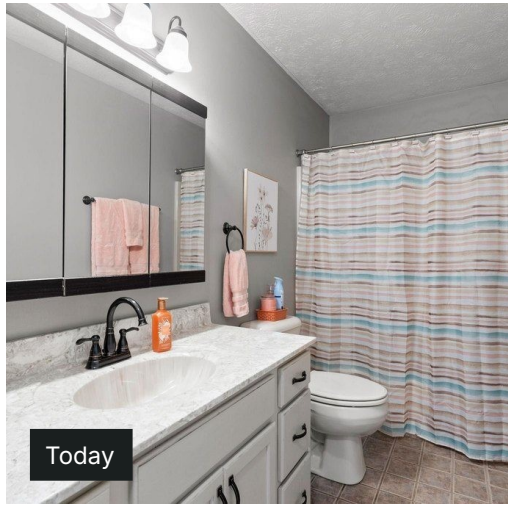
$34.5K / $49.3K / $74K (est.)

Freestanding tub, separate glass shower, 60–72-in double vanity, porcelain over a radiant mat, sconces, matching toilet.

Fit: comfortable at ~9 × 12 (est.); moves 1 non-bearing wall. This is the base budget.

Main bath: same tub-shower, two finishes

Both keep the 60-in acrylic tub-shower footprint, so no walls move. The office/guest room keeps its direct door. Size not in the listing (~6 × 6 ft in the 3D model, est.).



Today

Partly updated

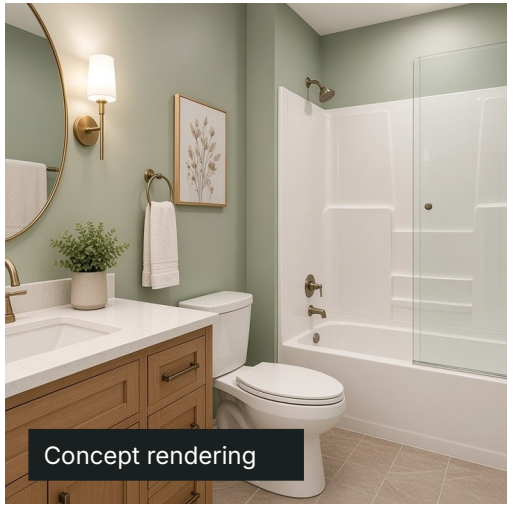
Gray vanity, cultured marble top, tub/shower with a curtain, tile floor.



A · Refresh

$8K / $12K / $18K (est.)

New acrylic tub-shower + sliding glass, keep the gray vanity with a quartz top, black fixtures, oak LVP.



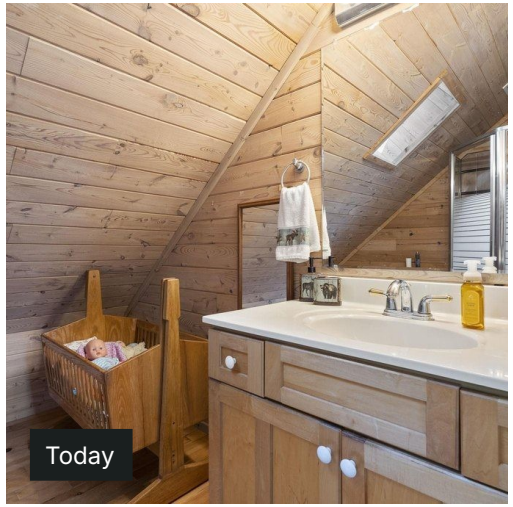
B · New vanity

$9K / $14K / $22K (est.)

Same tub-shower + hinged glass, oak vanity + quartz, brass fixtures, porcelain floor, sage walls.

Loft ¾ bath: shower only, no tub

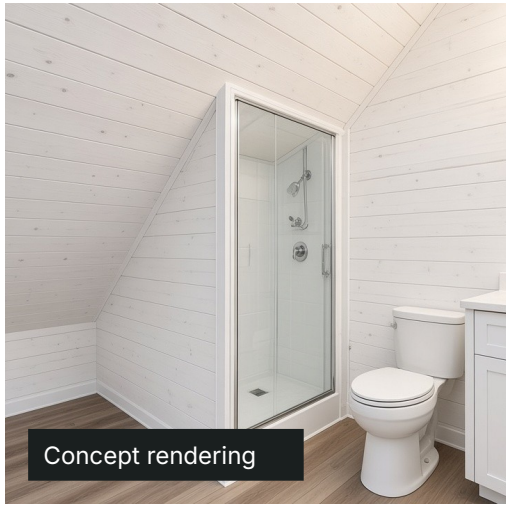
~45–60 sf (est., notes) under the roof slope. Keep the shower where there is full headroom; measure the slope before ordering.



Today

The most rustic room

Pine plank walls and ceiling, oak vanity, neo-angle corner shower.



A · Acrylic shower

$9.5K / $14.3K / $23K (est.)

Multi-piece acrylic shower, 30-in white vanity, pine painted white, oak LVP floor.



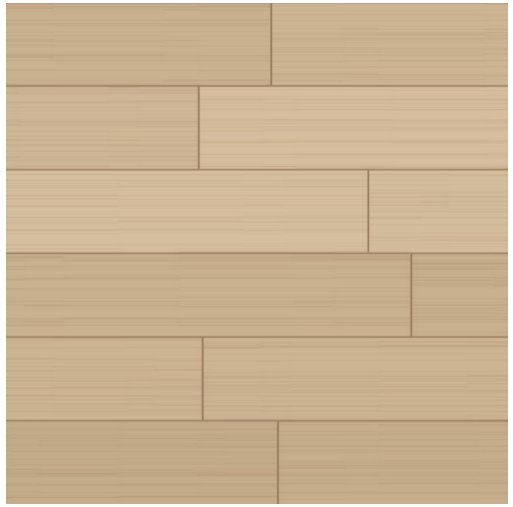
B · Tiled shower

$13.5K / $21.3K / $35K (est.)

Tiled shower + glass panel, oak vanity, pine kept natural, porcelain floor.

Finishes: light, quiet, continuous

Cosmetic only. Nothing structural inside the house. Mid estimates.



Floors

~$18K mid (est.)

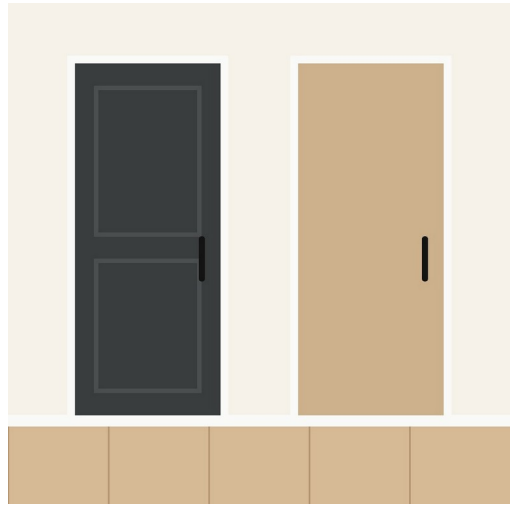
One oak-tone waterproof plank on every level, porcelain in the baths. See the flooring plan.



Paint

~$9–15K mid (est.)

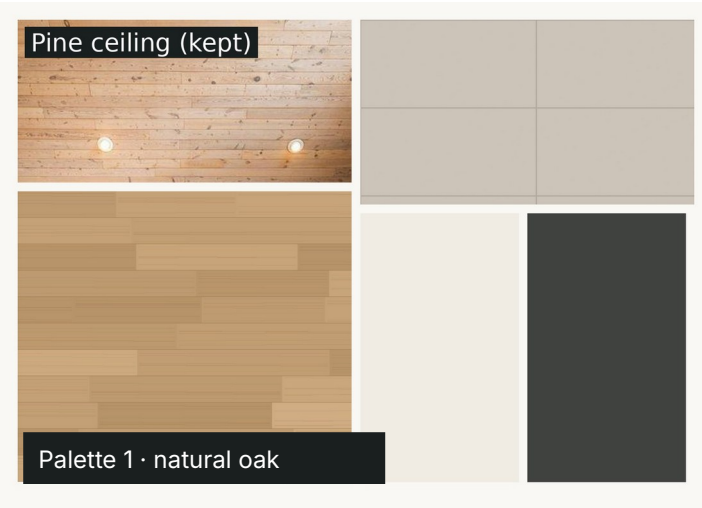
Warm white walls. Keep the great-room pine ceiling and trim; paint the loft pine only if wanted.

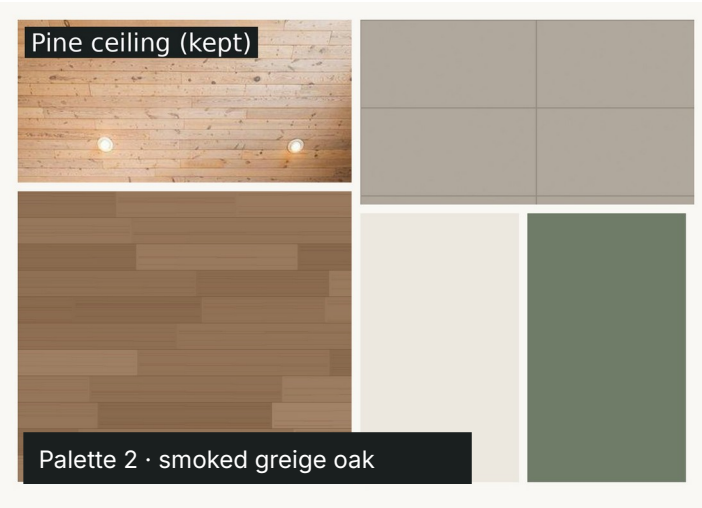


Doors & closets

~$13.5K mid (est.)

Modern slab or shaker doors, finished closets with doors; close off 1–2 openings, e.g. the lower French doors.





One floor, two tones under the pine

1 · Natural oak + greige porcelain, warm white, charcoal: lighter than the pine, so the ceiling leads.

2 · Smoked greige oak + taupe porcelain, soft white, muted green: grounds the room, hides walk-out grit.

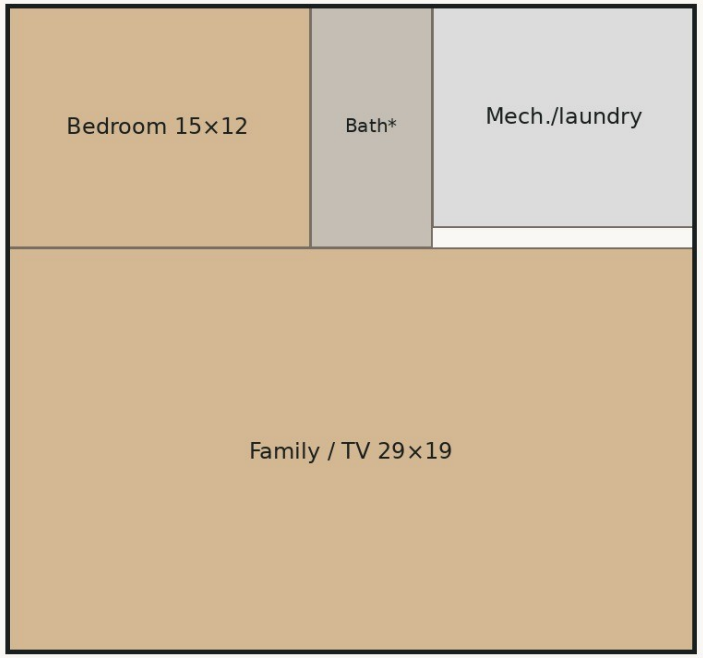
Either way: one waterproof plank everywhere, warm porcelain in the baths.



Flooring plan by level

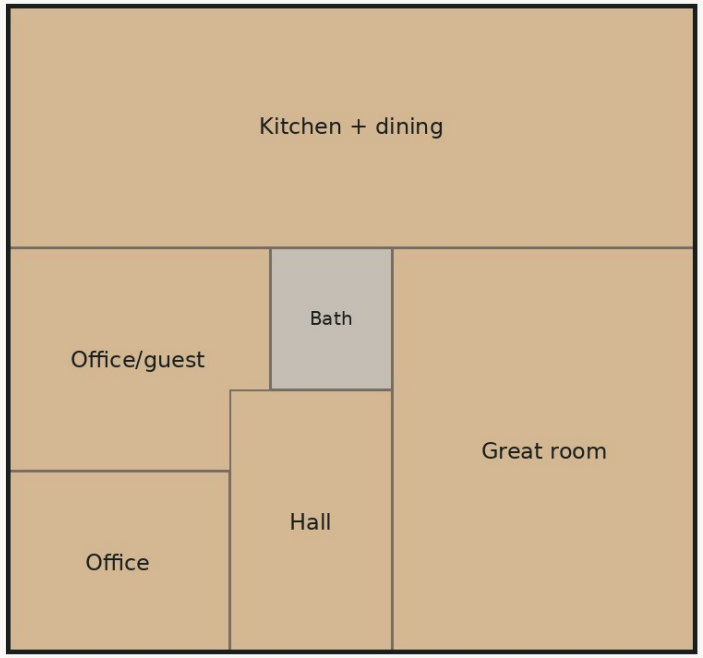
Lower (walk-out)

~900 sf finished (listing)



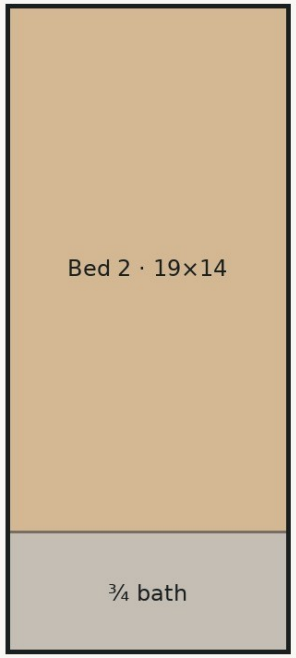
Main

~1,100 sf of 1,480 above grade (est.)



Loft

~380 sf (est.)



Oak LVP, one tone

Porcelain baths

Sealed concrete

~2,000 sf LVP

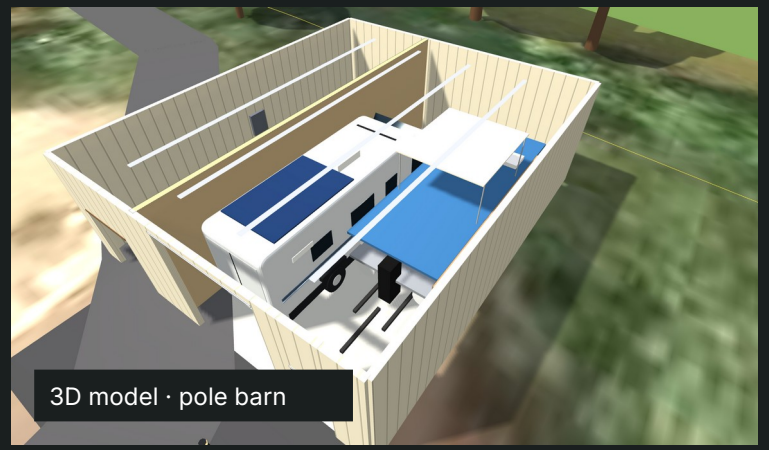
(est., notes)

*Radiant mat: lower bath
Vapor barrier on slab
Shapes approx., not to scale

~2,000 sf × $6.50 / $9 / $14 per sf incl. tear-out ≈ $13K / $18K / $28K (est.). Bath porcelain is in the bath lines; lower-bath radiant mat to be quoted.



Concept rendering



3D model · pole barn

Big barn: van + pontoon

Pole barn 32 × 38, insulated, with a subpanel. No structural work.

Large section

2022 Airstream Interstate 24X, a Class B camper van on a 2021 Mercedes Sprinter 3500 dually (~24 ft), plus the pontoon boat. The tall overhead door fits the van (confirmed in person).

Divider + power

Remove the interior divider only if it is a non-load-bearing partition (~$1–3K, est.). Add 50 A shore power for the van off the barn subpanel.



Concept rendering · small-barn gym

Small barn: CrossFit gym + recovery room

Train: pull-up rig as the centerpiece, barbells + bumper plates, rower/SkiErg, Peloton, curved treadmill, rubber floor. Most gear moves from Seabreeze.

Recover: 6 × 6 sauna and cold plunge corner. Budget ~$25K (est.) for the permit, code work and new gear; a gym bathroom ($25–60K) is optional.

Permit: no permit on record, so the second barn needs an after-the-fact permit with Grand Traverse County Construction Codes before new work.



Concept rendering

Solar in the open field, not on the roofs

Array (concept)

~20 kW ground mount

Storage (optional)

Powerwall 3 · 13.5 kWh each

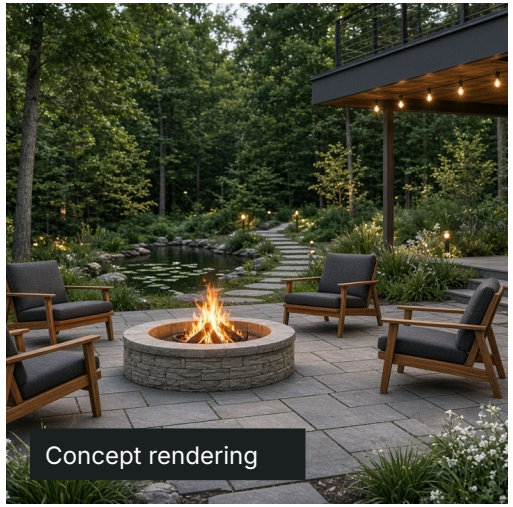
Why ground: snow and shade. A south-facing rack at 40–50° sheds snow and can be cleared by hand; wooded roofs could lose 20–50%.

Size: ~22,500 kWh/yr use → ~19 kW unshaded, 22–25 kW with shading (~50–60 panels). ~$3.00–3.80/W ≈ $60–76K for 20 kW (est.); ~20–25 yr payback.

Backup: optional central Powerwall 3 system at the house (2 units ~$24–32K, est.), outside the Phase 1 total; stay grid-tied.

A few extras worth planning

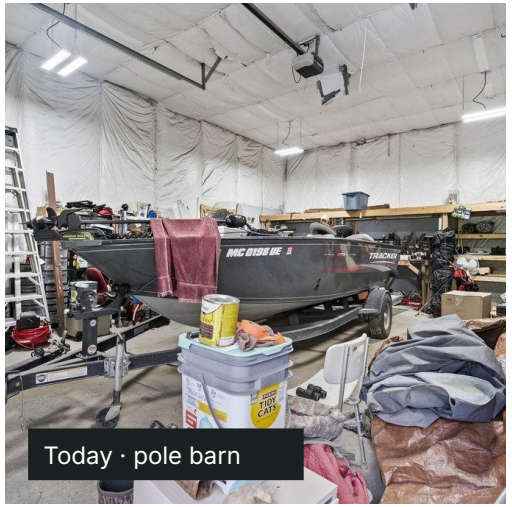
Estimate ranges (est.), not quotes.



Fire pit + landscaping

~$8.7–39.6K (est.)

Fire pit with a paver circle at the walk-out ($5.7–9.6K) and a landscaping refresh ($3–30K, avg ~$12K).



Barn shore power

~$0.6–1.8K (est.)

14-50 (50 A) plus 30 A outlets for the van in the pole barn, off the existing subpanel.



Generator + lighting

~$9–20.3K (est.)

Propane standby generator ($7–14.3K) and landscape and drive lighting ($2–6K).



3D model · future guest suite

Phase 2: guest suite (~2 years out)

The idea

Optional ~560 sf studio (20 × 28 ft) on the chalet's west side: queen bed, plug-in kitchenette, full bath, private entry, lockable pass-through.

Only if we still love the property and want to keep investing.

Before designing

Written ruling from the township and county: addition or second unit. Propane tank moves (~$0.5–1.5K); septic review (~$1–25K).

Phase 2 cost ~$140–290K (est.). Phase 1 + 2 ≈ $1.16M mid (est.), above the soft ~$1M target; see budget.

Seabreeze furniture: what moves, what's hard

Moves in: Steinway B, cigar chairs, bench and art panel (great room); glass desk + Aeron (small office); 75″ TV + console (lower); all gym gear (small barn).

Hard to fit: gray U-sectional (size not logged; walk-out delivery, or sell), massage chair (walk-out only; measure the slider), Milan's full bed (loft now twin + queen; optional), kids desk set (donate or store), art panel (height not logged).

Next: measure each piece at Seabreeze, then the openings at Samels.



3D model

Main level, dollhouse

Inferred floor plan; positions are approximate.

Budget vs. ~$1M target (soft)

Planning estimates, not quotes. Target ~$1M is soft; slightly over is OK. Purchase at the public list price (final TBD); excludes closing and moving. Optional, not in totals: gym bath $25–60K; 2 Powerwall 3 $24–32K.

Line	Range (est.)	Mid estimate
Purchase · public list price (final TBD)	—	$619,900
Interior remodel · mid incl. contingency	$115–315K	$187,000
Gym barn · after-the-fact permit, code work, gear	$15–40K	$25,000
Ground-mount solar · ~20 kW in the field	$60–76K	$68,000
400 A service upgrade	$4–10K	$7,000
Extras · fire pit, generator, lighting, shore power, landscaping	$18.3–61.7K	$35,400
Phase 1 total · ~$57.7K under the ~$1M target	**$832K–1.12M**	**~$942,300**
Phase 2 · guest suite addition (~2 years out)	$140–290K	~$215,000
Phase 1 + Phase 2 combined	**$972K–1.41M**	**~$1,157,300**

Option deltas vs. this base (mid, est.): lower bath A ≈ −$25K · main bath B ≈ +$2K · loft bath B ≈ +$7K · flooring tone 1 or 2: same cost.

Next: measure, ask, then close

Measure at the visit

Lower bath + the room behind it

Lower bedroom window (egress)

Barn divider: posts on that line?

Deck width at the widest corner

Loft knee wall · walk-out slider



Ask Toni and the seller

Electrical service size, panel brand and utility?

Why was the 1999 pole-barn permit terminated? Any permits for the second garage or shed?

Septic age, size and permitted bedrooms; well depth and pump age?

Propane tank owned or leased? Road association fee and plowing?

Closing terms: traditional possession at closing, with the property vacant, all personal property removed, and in its agreed condition.

Second barn: needs an after-the-fact permit (Grand Traverse County Construction Codes).

Live 3D model and site: https://clarkhuang.github.io/5312-samels-rd/



Listing photo